



“We built OriginOS 6 to feel...

... and not just function,” says Vivo

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There’s something poetic about the way Vivo is trying to talk about software these days. For years, Vivo built hardware that looked and felt premium, but when you unlocked the screen, the illusion often slipped. Funtouch OS was fast, packed with features, but too fragmented and cluttered to feel like a unified experience. It worked, yes, but it never flowed. With OriginOS 6, Vivo seems to be doing something it rarely gets credit for: slowing down, listening and rebuilding its foundation. We sat down with Vivo’s product team to pick their brain on this new direction they’re taking with the OriginOS.

From choice to originality

Vivo’s transition from Funtouch OS to Origin OS has been a long time coming. It was launched four years ago primarily for phones in China and this year it’s being extended to international markets.

“This shift is based on consumer need,” a Vivo spokesperson told me. “People are no longer choosing just hardware – they’re choosing the overall experience in which OS plays an important role.”

He compared it to buying a car. “When people enter a car now, they don’t start by asking how many seats it has. They talk about the experience. The same applies to smartphones. The in-cabin experience matters more than the engine.”

In other words, Vivo isn’t chasing specs anymore, it’s about mood, response, and rhythm. The company has realised that India’s smartphone users have matured. Many of them are on their third or fourth device, and they now want their devices to feel premium, not just look premium.

Defining smoothness

OriginOS 6 arrives under the banner “Smooth at Origin.” It’s easy to dismiss that as another marketing slogan until

you hear how Vivo defines “smooth.” “Smoothness is an experience. Experience is a feeling. You can’t compare it quantitatively, you can compare it to what you felt before,” he said.

He spoke about the modern user juggling everything at once: booking a cab, ordering dinner, paying bills, all while expecting their phone to keep up seamlessly. “We’ve benchmarked not against competitors, but against consumer expectations,” he said. “That’s where smoothness begins.”

Spend time with OriginOS 6, and you start to see what he means. The real measure of performance isn’t in frame rates or launch times, but in the absence of friction. Swiping through the control centre or juggling multiple apps feels less like navigating menus and more like gliding across one continuous surface.

User orientation = Core principle

My conversation with Vivo’s product team kept circling back to one phrase: user orientation.

“We try to identify the scenarios where vivo can provide the best experience,” they said. “Whether it’s through design, innovation, or understanding what’s next. Everything branches out of that.”

The new portrait filters that mimic Indian wedding styles, or the Diwali themes that light up your lock screen, aren’t just localisation efforts; it’s about emotional relevance.

“Premium experience,” he added, “isn’t niche anymore. It’s better for more people now. The definition has evolved over time.”

He illustrated it with a rather interesting analogy:

“When someone buys a Rs 20,000 phone, they want it to look and feel premium. They may not buy a Mercedes, but they expect their car, or phone, to give that sense of pride.” **D**

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